

magnitude is to try to understand its most popular sub-parts. The most common terms bandied about by tech company executives on forums on the Internet are Smart Data, Identity Data, and People Data. These terms are neither all-inclusive, nor are they self-explanatory, but they seem to be the ones that are going to outlast the others that are thrown around. So, to understand the scope of Big Data and what/whom it affects and how, these are the terms that should be most carefully looked at.

Smart Data

Let's look at the most popular of the three terms to begin with – Smart Data. Smart Data is essentially the sub-set of Big Data that can immediately be put into use. As previously stated, Big Data comprises of the 3 V's. Typically, a Big Data problem consists primarily of Volume and Velocity, with Variety taking a back seat. However, in the real world, a large part of any information collected using an algorithm is just meta-data having no immediate practical purpose. Smart Data, on the other hand, is more purposeful in its problem solving skills, focusing on the third V (that is, Veracity and Value) to sort out valuable, actionable information.

The sorting of Big Data traditionally calls for professionals having a high level of knowledge regarding data collection and interpretation, and takes a lot of time and effort to pre-process, clean, and accurately segment before it becomes valuable to a particular company. The beauty of Smart Data is that it allows for both qualitative and quantitative sorting of data. While this would still require an expert to make the Smart Data platform, it doesn't need their service any more than that, as trained marketing and research employees could further use the data. For example, if you were to add baby diapers and soy milk to your online supermarket cart, they could immediately process this data and, in the future use it to target baby-product advertisement to your IP address.

A smaller section of Smart Data is Fast Data – instantaneous results from a live input stream. Basically, it is the ability of a machine to give instantaneous results on the basis of a continuous stream of information provided to it. To better understand it, you could ask yourself whether you'd rather have an inch-perfect traffic report an hour after you asked for it, or a slightly less accurate version almost immediately. Obviously, the answer is the latter – and this sums up Fast Data. It is extremely fast analysis of data in a way that, if asked to choose, picks speed over accuracy.